

Activity 1 Instruction Manual

Activity 1 | Topic 01 | C013 | Version v1.0

Purpose

Work through the ten prompting patterns on a project of your own. You will see the same question answered badly by a vague prompt and well by a structured one, and you will keep a personal prompt library for the rest of the course.

Files used

- activity-guide.md and activity-guide.pdf - brief and source instructions
- prompts.pdf - reusable prompt and verification checklist
- mock-data.xlsx - safe fictional project data for practice

Expected output

A personal prompt library of 10 tested prompts, each with the output it produced and your critique.

Before you begin

1. Form the required group and assign one person to capture evidence.
2. Open mock-data.xlsx and review the title, note and column headings.
3. Open prompts.pdf beside your chosen GenAI tool. Do not upload confidential workplace data.

Detailed procedure

1. Open your preferred GenAI tool (ChatGPT, Claude, Gemini or Copilot) and sign in. Open the Project Manager Buddy GPT in a second tab: <https://chatgpt.com/g/g-hUcEmp6Rp-project-manager-buddy-project-management>
2. Choose a real project from your own workplace - one you know well enough to judge whether the AI output is sensible. Write down its objective, budget range and timeline in one sentence each.
3. Start with a deliberately vague prompt: 'Help me with my project.' Note how generic the answer is. This is your baseline.
4. Now apply the Persona pattern: 'Act as a stakeholder of the project. Perform an assessment of the project charter and provide a list of recommendations to improve scope clarity and completeness.' Compare against the baseline.
5. Apply the Flipped Interaction pattern so the AI interviews you: 'Ask me questions one at a time to prepare for a stakeholder update on [your project].' Answer at least five questions and note which gap it exposed.
6. Apply the Cognitive Verifier pattern to a complex question about your project - one that needs several sub-answers combined. Observe how it decomposes the question.
7. Apply the Fact Check List pattern to a question that depends on external industry data. Verify at least two of the sources it cites actually exist and say what it claims.
8. Record each prompt, the output and a one-line critique in your prompt library. Mark any output that was confidently wrong - this is the habit that protects you all course.

Use the supplied mock data

Copy only the rows needed for the current step and tell the model the data is fictional. If the model changes an identifier or number, reject the change and rerun with an explicit preserve-values instruction.

Quality control

- You have 10 prompts in your library, each with output and a critique, and you can state one concrete case where GenAI produced a plausible but wrong answer that you caught.
- Compare the first AI draft with the final human-corrected artifact and retain both as evidence.
- Label assumptions, decisions, owners and dates so another project manager can audit the result.

Troubleshooting

If the response is generic, add the project objective, constraints, audience and required columns. If arithmetic is inconsistent, request formulas and substitutions, then calculate independently. If a source cannot be opened, remove the claim or replace it with verified evidence.

Submission evidence

Submit the completed project artifact, the final prompt, a short critique of the AI output, and any screenshot or exported file required by the activity.